

Extended response to reading

Paper 1 • Question 4 • 20 marks | syllabus 2027–2029

What you will learn

Develop a faithful interpretation of a source in a purposeful letter, report, journal, speech, interview or article.

How this assessment works

All candidates take Paper 1. Centres then enter candidates for Paper 2 or the Coursework Portfolio. Speaking and Listening is optional and separately endorsed. The supplied June 2026 papers inform presentation only; question structure and word limits in this guide follow the 2027–2029 syllabus.

Read the task before drafting

Underline role, audience, form and every required bullet. Extract relevant details, then infer plausible thoughts from the source without contradicting it. Choose a controlled voice. This is a response to reading: 10 marks assess source use and 10 assess writing. The target is about 250–300 words.

Worked example

If writing as the caretaker, mention the storm, vulnerable glass, seed trays and the bird, then explain why visitors should act carefully. Do not invent a collapsed roof.

Develop, organise and adopt a form

Plan an opening with a clear purpose, two or three developed points grounded in the passage, and a closing action or reflection. Make the chosen form recognisable through address, headings or spoken cues only where useful. A diary may show private reflection; a report should state findings and recommendations.

Worked example

A report can turn the cracked pane and water collecting in a bucket into a specific maintenance recommendation: repair the pane before another storm, to protect visitors and plants.

Practice paper

Extended response to reading

All passages and questions in this FagusED practice are original. Write in English. Marks appear in square brackets. Use the lines provided; extra paper may be attached if required.

Name: _____

Date: _____

Quick check · FagusED diagnostic (outside the Cambridge paper)

A brief study check; the official 0500 written papers use structured and extended answers.

Which point stays faithful to the source?

- A The glass roof collapsed
- B The caretaker unlocked the gate twice
- C A cracked pane allows water to collect
- D The lemon tree was removed

Reading text

I reached the old glasshouse just as the rain began to drum on its roof. Through the misted panes I could see rows of wooden shelves and pots no larger than teacups. The door gave a reluctant sigh when I pushed it. Inside, warm air smelled of damp soil and oranges.

The caretaker had told me to fetch the seed trays before the storm grew worse. He had not mentioned that the central path narrowed between leaning towers of empty pots. Water was gathering beneath a cracked pane; each drop struck the same bucket with the measured patience of a clock. I stepped carefully, aware that the glass above me trembled whenever the wind changed direction.

At the far end stood a small lemon tree. One fruit glowed among the leaves like a lantern somebody had forgotten to extinguish. Beside it, the trays I needed were stacked neatly under a bench. I lifted them, then paused. From somewhere behind the shelves came a soft tapping, three quick sounds followed by silence. The caretaker had locked the outer gate after letting me in. I called out, and a blackbird burst from behind a watering can, brushing past my shoulder in a frantic flurry of feathers.

For a moment I laughed at myself. Then I noticed a square of blue sky reflected in the bucket: the rain had stopped. The glasshouse was quiet again, except for one last drop that fell, missed the bucket and darkened the path at my feet.

Questions

Answers and teacher guidance

4. Model response (about 267 words). Report to the owners: glasshouse condition after the storm. The glasshouse remained accessible during today's rain, but it needs attention before the next period of bad weather. Water came through a cracked pane and collected in a bucket. Wind made the glass above the central path tremble, while empty pots leaned into the narrow aisle.

A visitor sent to collect the seed trays would have had to pass these obstacles while carrying a stack in poor weather. That combination makes a slip or a falling pot a reasonable concern, even though no injury was reported. A blackbird was also behind the shelves. It startled the visitor when it flew out; we should check how birds can enter without disturbing any nesting place.

There is much here worth preserving. The air is warm, the trays were stored neatly beneath a bench, and the lemon tree still has fruit. These details suggest that the growing area is productive and cared for, despite the damaged roof and untidy aisle.

I recommend replacing the cracked pane, inspecting the other panes and clearing a full-width route to the far bench. The wet patch should be dried and monitored after the repair. During strong wind or heavy rain, I suggest keeping visitors outside until a check has been completed. Finally, the pots should be stacked securely and the seed trays moved to a reachable shelf. These measures would protect both the people using the glasshouse and the plants that give it its value. Reading [10]: accurate selection, inference and supported recommendations. Writing [10]: report form, organisation, register and

precision.

Diagnostic answer

1: C

Source for assessment structure: Cambridge IGCSE First Language English 0500 syllabus for 2027–2029, <https://www.cambridgeinternational.org/Images/718783-2027-2029-syllabus.pdf>. Original passages and questions by FagusED; June 2026 papers and mark schemes supplied by the user consulted for response layout and feedback style. This is independent study material, not an official Cambridge paper.